



24.4 REWRITE THESE SENTENCES IN THE PAST SIMPLE USING "COULD"

I **can** ski.

I could ski.

- 1 I **can** cook Italian food.
- 2 We **can't** play the piano.
- 3 She **can** paint a picture.
- 4 They **can't** make a cake.



24.5 LISTEN TO THE AUDIO AND MARK THE CORRECT ANSWERS

When Diana was five, she couldn't...

write music ☒

read music ☐

play the piano. ☐

2 When Imelda was seven, she could...

ride a horse ☐

drive a car ☐

fly a plane. ☐

1 When Louis was four, he could...

read ☐

write ☐

do mathematics. ☐

3 When Irina was four, she could speak...

one language ☐

two languages ☐

three languages. ☐



24.6 USE THE CHART TO CREATE 16 CORRECT SENTENCES AND SAY THEM OUT LOUD

*When I was five,
I couldn't play
chess.*



When I was
When you were

Start with a
"when" phrase.

five,
seven,

Choose
an age.

I couldn't
you could

Choose a positive or
negative statement.

play chess.
ride a bike.
swim.
skate.

Finish with
an ability.



24 CHECKLIST



Using "could" in the past simple ☐



Abilities and pastimes ☐



Talking about past abilities ☐